

Welcome to the scrumptious world of



Group 9 – Adrien, Ankit, Jake, Prithish



UCD Michael Smurfit
Graduate Business School



What's on the Menu?

01. Introduction & Company Overview

02. Market & Competition Overview

03. Brand & Company growth roadmap

04. Operations & Expansion strategy

05. Conclusion & Q&A



01.

Introduction & Company Overview

SOS Cookies: Our Story & Vision



About SOS Cookies

Founded December 2020, SOS Cookies is an innovative Irish brand known for its vibrant pop-ups and kiosks in major retail centers. The company has built strong loyalty among young consumers and parents, driving rapid nationwide growth.

Sarah O'Sullivan

Creative force and CEO, Sarah O'Sullivan, started as a self-taught baker during lockdown. Inspired by childhood memories of London's Millie's Cookies and her food innovation background, "SOS" stands for her initials, embodying her passion.

Project Aim

Rapidly scale SOS Cookies across Ireland through kiosks, pop-ups, and permanent retail. Our focus is on identifying precisely where, when, and how to strategically expand next.

Brand Vision

To be Ireland's most-loved destination for creative, high-quality cookies-bringing moments of joy to every community while championing local, innovative, and customer-driven growth.





02.

Market & Competition Overview

Market & Category Overview



CONSUMER SPENDING
& FOOTFALL AT
RECORD HIGHS



SHOPPING CENTRES
NEAR FULL
OCCUPANCY



TREATS MARKET
GROWING AT 4-5%
CAGR



COOKIES ARE
IRELAND'S NEWEST
DESSERT TREND



TIKTOK & INSTA
FUELING COOKIE
HYPE



Customer & Competition



Parameter	SOS Cookies	The Cookie Coop (Cookies)	Green Island Bakery (Cookies)	The Rolling Donut (Donuts)	Offbeat Donuts (Donuts)
Average Order Size	Approx. €6 per order	Not publicly specified	Not publicly specified	Box of 12 donuts (price varies)	Price varies, typically box sets
Target Customer Segment	Teenage TikTok-driven youth; Parents as gatekeepers; Corporate clients	Artisan cookie lovers, broad spectrum	Premium Irish-European treats lovers	Donut lovers seeking traditional & gourmet options	Donut lovers, fresh and unique recipes enthusiasts
Brand Positioning	Homegrown, trend-led, accessible premium cookies	Artisan, quality ingredients, hand-crafted	Handmade authentic Irish-European luxury baked goods	Fresh, traditional to gourmet donuts	Handmade, innovative donut recipes
Sales Channels	Pop-ups & kiosks in malls, online, wholesale to coffee shops, corporate orders	Boutique and online	Bakery and online sales	Retail outlets, events, online orders	Retail and delivery
Brand Differentiators	Strong social media engagement, bespoke flavors, corporate personalization	Artisan quality, signature taste focus	Authenticity, European style luxury	Variety from traditional to vegan & gourmet	Unique flavors, daily fresh bake
Operational Challenges	Staffing for pop-ups & kitchen, ingredient cost & availability, logistics	Not detailed publicly	Not detailed publicly	Scaling production, maintaining freshness	Consistent daily production quality
Expansion Considerations	Exploring permanent stores vs pop-ups, using customer feedback for location	N/A	N/A	Established local brand, growth via retail	Growth via expanding delivery and retail
Price Positioning	Entry-level to premium affordable	Premium pricing typical	Premium/luxury pricing	Mid-range pricing	Mid-range pricing

Customer & Competition



Customers

Core Audience:

Gen Z & Millennials -driven by TikTok/Instagram engagement

Broadening Reach:

Families, tourists, professionals via high-footfall retail locations

Purchase Drivers: Novelty, indulgence, visual appeal, gifting

Competition

Rolling Donut Benchmark

Scaled multi-location treat brand

Strong footfall presence in Dublin shopping centres

Lower price point, broader bakery offering :

Demonstrates market demand for indulgent, grab-and-go treats

Other Competitors: Cafés, donut brands, emerging cookie startups

Market Gap: *No clear premium cookie leader in Ireland*

Competitive advantage

Stronger Gen Z brand equity through social-media virality

Premium positioning with higher average transaction value

Clear product differentiation: thicker, indulgent, trend-led cookies

Additional revenue streams: online gifting & corporate custom orders

Key Insight for Expansion



Pop-ups work → Dundrum exceeded forecasts

Capacity limits growth → kitchen expansion in progress

Kiosks = low-risk, high-reward format

Prioritise Dublin; delay flagship until proven

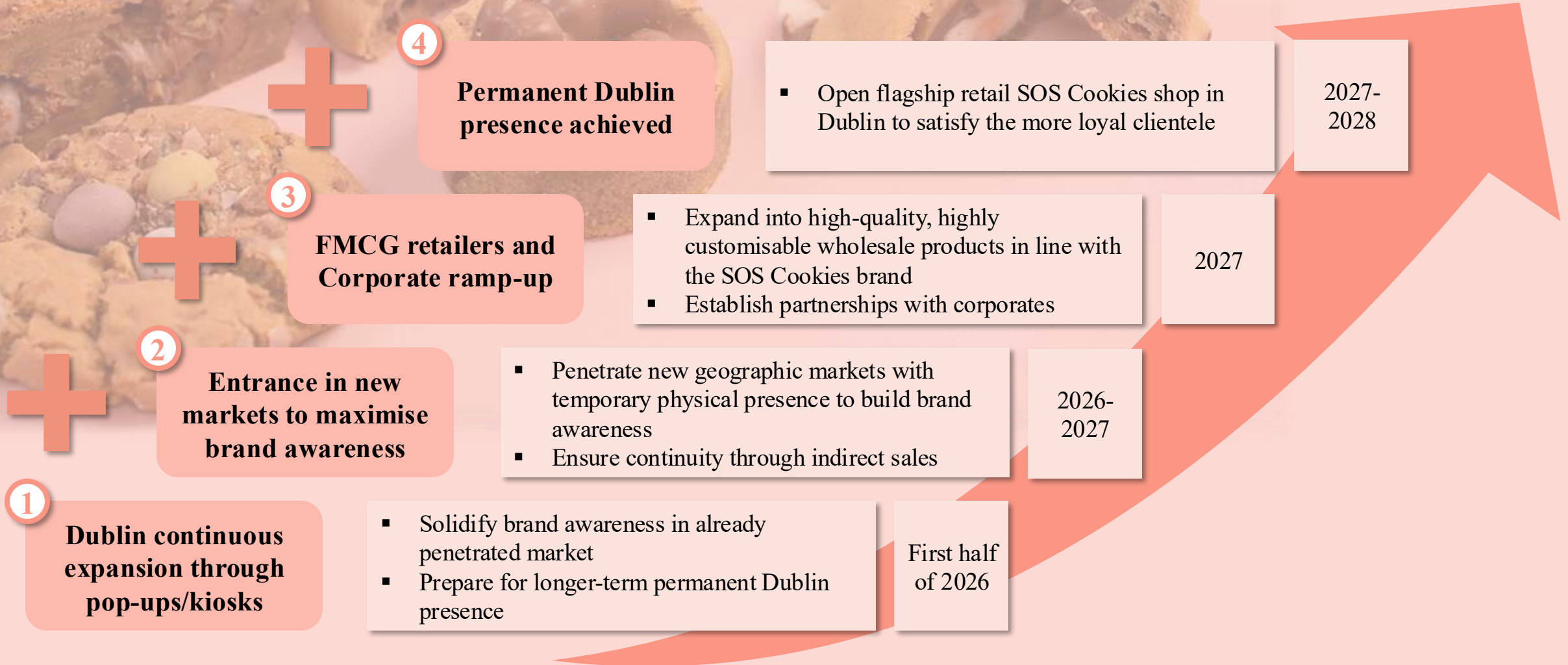
Grow smart → reinvest profits, tap corporate channel



03.

Brand & Company growth roadmap

Brand growth rollout roadmap – recommended short-to-long term actions



Short term – continuous Dublin expansion to solidify clientele



Liffey Valley Shopping Centre



Tallaght Town Centre



UCD Belfield Campus



Timeline

First half of 2026
6-month period

First half of 2026
6-month period

Near exam seasons (spring 2026)
1-month period

Population & Main client type

c.8.5 million visitors p.a.
Families & teenagers

c.5 million visitors p.a.
Families & teenagers

c.40k university students

Competition

Low – Rolling Donut but no premium
cookie distributor

Low – no premium cookie distributor

Low – no premium cookie distributor

Rationale

Capture West Dublin area in premium
shopping centre

Capture Southwest Dublin area in
premium shopping centre

Targets adjacent market (students)
with propensity for buying treats

Medium term – Grow brand by expanding into new markets



	Cork	London
Exact Location	Mahon Point Shopping Centre	Westfield London Shepherd's Bush
Timeline	Second Half of 2026 6-months period (extendable)	2027 3-month period (extendable)
Population & Main client type	c.6 million visitors p.a. Families & teenagers	c.28 million visitors p.a. Families & teenagers
Competition	Low – No premium cookie distributor	High – Ben's Cookies is a direct premium cookie competitor, although mitigated by size of the mall and brand's unique story
Rationale	▪ Establish SOS Cookies presence in second largest city in Ireland, building brand awareness in key Irish market ▪ Opportunity to build local and loyal customer base, enabling SOS Cookies to sell their products in Cork indirectly ▪ Lower operational costs than in Dublin with extensive footfall leading to higher profit margin	▪ Coming full circle on the origin story of SOS Cookies by establishing a physical presence in the location where the idea was born ▪ Opportunity to expand internationally after having grown the brand in the Irish market ▪ Larger footfall location with opportunity to grow brand awareness exponentially

Medium-to-long term – Strategic partnerships to drive growth & profitability



By addressing FMCG retailers and corporates specifically, SOS Cookies can benefit from higher profit margins while also developing brand awareness:



- Addressing a new market and new type of clientele (more senior clients) by maintaining high-quality standards but lowering the price per unit.
- Generate higher cash flow which can be used to invest in new production capabilities and potential opening of permanent Dublin flagship store

Premium FMCG retailers

Marks & Spencer



- Strong brand fits with premium offering with average customers more like to be willing to trade up
- High volumes provide opportunity to scale up

Corporate Partnerships



- Potential to partner with iconic brands with established Ireland presence and extensive employee well-being programmes
- Opportunity for regular orders with high profit margins

Long-term – Flagship Dublin permanent store opening



Flagship Store enables new capabilities

- Opening a flagship store entails new opportunities to further develop SOS Cookies' brand:
 - Sit-down experience and potential to offer new complementary products (e.g. coffee).
 - Potential to create immersive experiences for younger clients.

Operational feasibility and compatibility with current model

- Efforts to improve profitability with retailers and corporate actions will enable cash-flow necessary to front the cost of opening a flagship store
- With a permanent flagship store, pop-ups and kiosks will directly serve as an advertisement tool towards the flagship location

Brand Awareness & Values

- Efforts since 2025 to build brand awareness across Ireland entails that by 2027 SOS Cookies will be established enough to warrant a permanent store opening.
- SOS Cookies is a community-led brand: opening a permanent location means the community/clientele can meet at a precise and permanent location.



04.

Operations & Expansion strategy

Overcoming Operational Constraints



Production Capacity

Current: 2,400 cookies daily from Limerick kitchen

Constraint: Can support max 9-10 locations (3-4 new beyond current 6)

Scaling beyond requires €50k-€100k equipment investment or €200k-€300k second facility

Recommendation: Limit 2026 expansion to 3-4 locations

Staffing & Recruitment

Need 12-16 additional retail staff for expansion

Challenge: High turnover, difficult recruitment

Mitigation: Pay €14-15/hr, local hiring, structured training

Recommendation: Stagger openings (1 per quarter)

Logistics & Distribution

Current: 2 routes (Dublin corridor, Limerick local)

Dublin expansion fits existing routes

Cork requires dedicated route (+€4k/month)

Recommendation: Prioritise Dublin 2026, Cork Q4 2026

Expanding Reach: Growing the SOS Cookies Customer Base



SOS Cookies is poised for significant growth by strategically introducing innovative products, targeting new demographics, and solidifying the position as the premier Cookie brand.

Product Innovation

Colourful & Fictional Character
Cookies for Children

SOS Mini Bites for Portion
Controlled Snacking

**Healthy Delights made of Oats,
Almonds, Dates** for
Health Conscious Adults

Customer Engagement

Broad Appeal: Kids, Health
Conscious Adults, and all snacking
adults

Social Media Campaigns
#MiniBiteChallenge

Experiential Marketing Partner with
influencers, food vloggers, and
increasing connection over brand
story

Strategic Positioning & Future Growth

Dual Positioning Creative
and nutritious

Clear Messaging Emphasizing
portion control and healthy
ingredients

Pilot Programs New products at
pop-up locations, supported by social
media and local partnerships

Insight: The Irish retail landscape shows a rising demand for healthy, innovative snacks. Social media and influencer marketing are key growth levers. Bundling and cross-promotion boost average order value, while authentic local branding distinguishes SOS in a competitive market.



Accelerating Brand Visibility: Smart Marketing with AI & Influencers



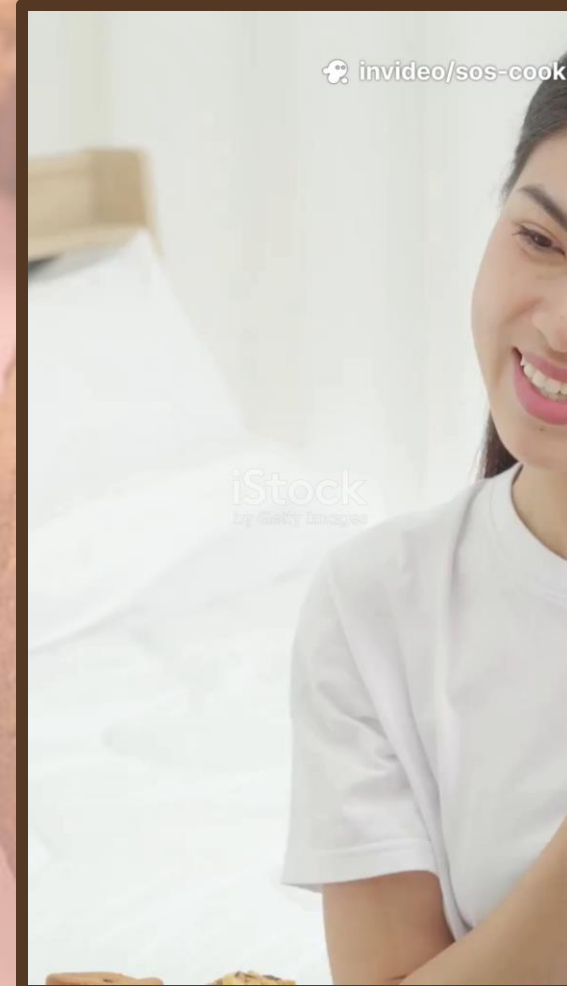
Appealing to untapped customer base



Early adoption of AI for Marketing campaigns



Influencer based marketing



How?

Hire Marketing Intern with AI video editing skills and has social media/campaign management skills

Note:

*AI tools used first for prompt generation – ChatGPT/Gemini
AI video editing tool used to create the final output - like ai.invideo.io*



05. Conclusion & Q&A

Summarised Recommendations and Conclusion



BUILD BRAND CONSISTENCY

- Maintain same quality, service, looks and packaging.
- Create clear brand style and visual guidelines

UPHOLD CRAFTMANSHIP STANDARDS

- Centralised production for quality control.
- Ingredient transparency to earn customer trust.

INCREASE DIGITAL PRESENCE

- Post short videos and reels of real customer moments.
- Collaborate with influencers matching brand vibe.



HIGHLIGHT FOUNDER’S JOURNEY

- Walk people through Sarah’s journey.
- Post behind the scene videos for personal touch.

COMMITMENT TO CORPORATE SOCIAL RESPONSIBILITY

- Use eco-friendly and recyclable packaging.
- Support local charity initiatives.

CUSTOMER RETENTION

- Innovating new products like minis, character cookies.
- Launch a Cookie Club for regular customers.

Thank You



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